

	Republic of the Philippines Department of Transportation
	Document No: <u>DOTr-HRDD-Forms-004</u> Rev. No.: <u>001</u> Effective Date: <u>03 August 2022</u>
	RE-ENTRY ACTION PLAN (REAP) FORM

INSTRUCTIONS: This form is used in preparing a proposed Re-entry Action Plan in applying to a Scholarship Program. Duly accomplished and signed forms will be submitted to the HRD Division along with the other documentary requirements.

Title of Scholarship Program:	Australian Awards Scholarship
Name of the Development Partner	Australia Awards and Alumni Engagement Program - Philippines (AAAEP-P)

I. REAP BACKGROUND AND INFORMATION	
a. REAP Title	Enhancing Passenger Safety in Railway Transportation: Development of QR Code-Based Grievance Redress Mechanism (“ GRM ”) for Harassment Reporting
b. REAP Objective	This REAP aims to develop an efficient and technology-integrated GRM system that uses Quick Response Code (“QR Code”) based reporting that enables passengers to report discreetly and swiftly harassment incidents that occurring within Metro Rail Transit Line 3 (“MRT3”) trains or at the station's premises to improve safety for all commuters, especially the vulnerable sectors (women, persons with disabilities etc.).
c. Problem/Opportunity	Social Connectivity affected by Safety Social connectivity greatly depends on the safety and security of transportation systems. As transportation is essential to daily life, people’s ability to form and maintain social relationships is closely linked to how safely they can move around. When safety is lacking, people limit their mobility and avoid public or active transportation modes such as walking, biking, or riding trains and buses. Instead, they turn to perceived safer options like private or rental vehicles, even if these are less accessible or sustainable. Ceccato and Loukaitou-Sideris (2020) emphasize that a safe city provides risk-free environments where all individuals can move freely without fear of harm. This includes not only private car use but also public transport, walking, and cycling. Their findings show that including safety in transport planning enhances people’s ability to connect socially. Harassment in Public Transportation Biana, Yabut, Jabar, and Domingo (2023) revealed alarming statistics in their study, reporting that Manila has one of the highest incidences of sexual harassment in public transportation—with 90% of women reporting experiences in buses and 80% in trains. Due to limited transportation alternatives, many women have adopted self-defense practices, such as carrying safety alarms or weapons, and staying hyper-aware of their surroundings. The study recommends improvements in transit infrastructure and the implementation of technology-based solutions for quick access to information and timely intervention by

	authorities. In one of the Department of Transportation's railway projects, our team conducted Courtesy Calls to various Local Government Units ("LGUs") to gain insights on potential environmental and social impacts. During a discussion on April 3, 2025, a male employee from an LGU's E&S division disclosed his own experience of harassment while riding the train. However, due to prevailing social stigma and the absence of clear reporting processes, he remained silent about the incident, emphasizing the urgent need for more accessible and inclusive mechanisms for reporting harassment. Relation to Government Development Plan The Philippine Development Plan ("PDP") 2023–2028 highlights the importance of infrastructure in achieving social and economic transformation. Chapter 12 addresses the persistence of gender-based violence and harassment in public spaces, which remains largely underreported. Despite laws like the Safe Spaces Act, interventions remain fragmented. MRT data from 2016–2018 reported 30 cases of harassment against women and six against men. Aligned with AmBisyon Natin 2040, which envisions convenient, affordable, and safe transport, Filipinos aspire to live in an environment free from fear and harassment. Similarly, the Australian Government's Sustainable Development Goals, particularly Chapter 5 on Gender Equality, emphasize the elimination of discrimination and harassment to ensure equal participation in public life. Safe Spaces Act and Introduction to REAP Republic Act No. 11313, the Safe Spaces Act, defines and penalizes gender-based harassment in public, private, and digital spaces. It guarantees every individual's right to safety and dignity. Following the above, In MRT 3, the applicant gathered data on existing harassment reporting procedures and found that the system requires a formal letter to the management—an approach that discourages urgent reporting. To address this, the applicant proposes a QR code-based, tech-integrated GRM in collaboration with the DOTr-Computer and Network Systems Division. The platform will allow victims or witnesses to report discreetly using mobile devices, streamlining case handling from submission to resolution. QR codes will be placed throughout stations and trains, ensuring the tool is accessible and visible, with clear processes and timelines for action. This approach aims to build a safer and more responsive transport environment.
d. Description in relation to the Department i. Organizational Outcome	In this specialized training program, the following organizational outcomes will be addressed by this REAP, a. Enhancement of Service Delivery. This Department has always been committed to delivering a Comfortable, Accessible, Safe, Sustainable, and Affordable ("CASSA") transportation system. A transportation system that supports a Gender Equality, Inclusivity and Responsive environment. Given that the applicant is an active member of Gender and Development Technical Working Group ("GADTWG") and an advocate of Gender Equality, Disability and Social Inclusion ("GEDSI"), the applicant strongly recognizes



Republic of the Philippines
Department of Transportation

Document No: DOTr-HRDD-Forms-004 Rev. No.: 001 Effective Date: 03 August 2022

RE-ENTRY ACTION PLAN (REAP) FORM

	the importance of addressing sexual harassment within the transportation system. Taking the initiative to implement solutions within a single railway line can serve as a meaningful starting point—laying the groundwork for broader, long-term programs and policies aimed at preventing and responding to sexual harassment across the entire transport sector. b. System Development. By developing a QR code-based reporting platform, the process of reporting for sexual harassment will be streamlined and accessible to victims, allowing them to report swiftly and discreetly. c. Policy Evaluation and Formulation. The developed GRM will serve as a framework for the CODI to ensure that all sexual harassment reports are processed properly, fairly, and efficiently, which in turn contributes to creating a safer environment for passengers. d. Building Competencies. This study will develop and implement an efficient and technology-integrated GRM system. In implementing this system, MRT3 CODI will be adequately prepared and trained to operate and manage the new reporting platform effectively. This includes equipping them with the necessary technical knowledge, tools, and protocols to ensure they can respond to reports promptly and appropriately.
ii. Target Competency Improvement	The applicant intends to pursue a Master's degree in Public Policy in Monash University, an institution that offers courses that will enhance understanding of policy formation processes, the implementation of policy initiatives, and the political and structural factors that shape policy decision-making. The course comprises 96 points structured into four parts: a. Principal Study. The applicant will explore core aspects of public policy, including its processes, analysis, implementation, evaluation, and governance. b. Applied Study. The applicant will engage in professional or academic work that contributes to their portfolio of professional development. c. Professional Enhancement. The applicant will enhance their skills by completing modules designed with industry experts, supporting their chosen career path. d. Specialist Study. The applicant will develop expertise in a selected specialization: either Policy Studies or Global Studies. The content of this training program will enhance my knowledge in; a. Insights on Government Operation. This training program will provide the applicant with a comprehensive understanding of the various operations and processes within government branches.

	b. Improve Policy Development and Formulation. This training program will increase the ability of the applicant in analyzing, designing and formulating policies that society needs. c. Enhancement of Service Delivery. This training program will broaden the applicant's understanding of the diverse needs of the public, with a focus on improving and addressing these needs effectively. d. Improve Leadership and Responsibility. This training program will introduce the applicant on the different principles in ethics, integrity and responsibility in the public. e. Introduction to Social Equity. This training program will broaden the applicant's knowledge in social inclusivity and equality. The competencies that will be gained during the training program will guide the applicant to understand and properly execute the REAP.
e. Relation to the Government's Development Plan	The Philippine Development Plan 2023 - 2028 ("PDP") was formulated to plan for a deep economic and social transformation by steering the economy back on a high growth path. The Chapter 12 Expand and Upgrade Infrastructure of the PDP highlights that gender-based violence, sexual exploitation, abuse, harassment, and discrimination remain common and likely underreported in public spaces, including transportation. Despite existing laws like the Safe Spaces Act, efforts to address these issues have been limited and fragmented. According to MRT Incident Monitoring System 2016-2018, there were 30 reported case of sexual harassment against women, and six against men. The AmBisyon Natin 2040 is a representation of the collective long term vision and aspirations of Filipinos for themselves and for the country in the next 25 years. In this, Filipinos aspire for transportation to be convenient and affordable. Additionally, Filipinos want to feel safe in all places of the country without fearing harassment or danger. The Australian Government Sustainable Development Goals ("SDGs") is an universal global approach that aims to reduce poverty, promote sustainable development and ensure peace and prosperity of people across the word. In Chapter 5 Gender Equality of Australian Government SDGs, Australian promotes the addressing of violence, discrimination and harassment. Sex discrimination, sexual harassment and assault, which are prohibited by the law, create barriers to women's full participation in public life. Subsequently, the objective of the applicant's REAP is fully aligned with and supports the PDP, AmBisyon 2040 and Australian Government SDGs. Furthermore, the applicant's REAP will address the issues of gender-based violence, sexual exploitation, abuse, harassment, and discrimination in MRT3.
f. Direct Beneficiary	As of 2025, MRT-3 serves approximately 400,000 passengers daily, with a total ridership of 135 million recorded in 2024. Following recent decisions by the DOTr and MRT-3 to extend operating hours and deploy additional rolling stock during peak periods, passengers now benefit from a more convenient and comfortable commuting experience. These enhancements are expected to drive further increases in ridership. Upon implementation, this REAP will immediately cover all MRT-3 passengers. Its introduction, alongside the activation of MRT-3's



Republic of the Philippines
Department of Transportation

Document No: DOTr-HRDD-Forms-004 Rev. No.: 001 Effective Date: 03 August 2022

RE-ENTRY ACTION PLAN (REAP) FORM

	Committee on Decorum and Investigation (“CODI”), aims to serve as a strong deterrent against gender-based violence, sexual exploitation, abuse, harassment, and discrimination. More than just a preventive measure, the REAP will also symbolize a renewed commitment to safety for the riding public, contributing to an improved quality of life and a more positive overall experience for commuters. Importantly, the adoption of this REAP in MRT-3 is envisioned as a stepping stone toward broader change. The long-term goal is to standardize and implement this system across all railway lines in the Philippines, establishing a unified, technology-driven approach to protecting passengers and promoting safe, inclusive public transportation nationwide. The applicant has already presented the proposed REAP to MRT-3’s CODI, who expressed full support for its implementation.
g. Gender Equality, Disability, and Social Inclusion (GEDSI)	The primary objective of this REAP is to ensure that passengers of MRT3 experience safety and security and prevent gender-based violence, sexual exploitation, abuse, harassment, and discrimination. As such, GEDSI will be the top priority of this REAP.
h. Output	Upon completion of the training program, the applicant will develop an efficient and technology-integrated GRM system at MRT3. This proposed system will utilize a QR code-based reporting platform to streamline the process and make it more accessible for users. The GRM will be designed to cover the full lifecycle of a report: from the moment a victim submits a complaint, to its acknowledgment and handling by the CODI, including the establishment of clear timelines for response, investigation procedures, and potential disciplinary action. This system aims to ensure that all reports are processed properly, fairly, and efficiently. The applicant will organize capacity-building training for the CODI to equip them with necessary technical knowledge, tools, and protocols to ensure they can respond to reports promptly and appropriately.
II. REAP TIMELINE AND IMPLEMENTATION	
III. Measurability	To ensure that progress of the implementation of this REAP is on track, the output will be measured in the following milestones, - At 25%, the Applicant will gather insights from existing practices and experiences of railway operational and private sectors and research on international’s best practices known for their effectiveness in handling gender-based harassment cases - At 50%, the Applicant will develop an GRM, based on the insights and data gathered. - At 75%, the Applicant will develop a QR code-based reporting platform with assistance of DOTr-CNSD. In addition, - At 100%, the Applicant will present the Department Order regarding the implementation and operationalization of GRM.

e. Sustainability	Diokno (2021), in the Philippine Star, stated that the adoption of QR Ph for person-to-person payments has gained significant traction, particularly during the health crisis. QR codes have proven to be a convenient, faster, and more cost-effective method for digital transactions, reflecting the public’s growing preference for accessible and contactless technologies. Following this, the proposed GRM will integrate a QR code-based reporting system as a long-term solution, formalized through a Department Order. This system will allow passengers to quickly and discreetly report cases of gender-based violence, sexual exploitation, abuse, harassment, and discrimination using their mobile phones. By leveraging the simplicity and familiarity of QR codes, along with the availability of free Wi-Fi in MRT-3 stations, the GRM aims to ensure accessibility, encourage reporting, and provide timely responses. To ensure effectiveness and sustainability, the GRM will be continuously monitored and evaluated, with any necessary revisions and adjustments made to ensure long-term sustainability.	
f. Predictive Action Steps with Identified Success Indicators		
i. Phase/Stage	ii. Expected Output	iii. Timeline
1. Gathering of Relevant references and insights from stakeholders	Relevant references and data	2 Months to 3 Months
2. Development GRM	GRM	5 Months to 6 Months
3. Development of QR code-based reporting system	QR code-based reporting system	3 Months to 4 Months
4. Presentation of the Department Order regarding the implementation and operationalization of GRM (100%)	Draft Department Order of GRM	2 Months to 3 Months
1. Target Date to Start	2027	
2. Target Date to End	2029	
3. RESOURCES		
All budgetary requirements for the effective implementation of this REAP, particularly the allocation for the development of GRM, QR code-based reporting system and Capacity Buildings, will be sourced from the mandated 5% budget allocation for GAD initiatives, as stipulated in Republic Act No. 9710, Section 37(a).		
4. COMMENT(S) AND RECOMMENDATION(S)		
a. Immediate Superior (Mentor)	Ar. Marie Koreen C. Hidalgo	
b. Head of the Office/Division/Service	Asec. Leonel P. De Velez	
c. Human Resource Development Division		



Republic of the Philippines
Department of Transportation

Document No: DOTr-HRDD-Forms-004 Rev. No.: 001 Effective Date: 03 August 2022

RE-ENTRY ACTION PLAN (REAP) FORM

Prepared by:


Mary Bernadette E. Reyes

Name of Applicant with signature

Recommended by:


Ar. Marie Koreen C. Hidalgo

Immediate Supervisor with signature (Mentor)

Approved and noted by:


Asec. Leonel Cray P. De Velez

Head of the Office/Division/Service with signature